

06/08/2025

On the mend, Defenestrate, Preposterous, Onslaught, Debilitated

1. On the mend (ठीक हो रहा है) (Phrase) (on-the-mend) (Neutral/Optimistic)

- **Meaning (English):** Improving in health or condition after an illness or a bad situation
- **Meaning (Hindi):** स्वास्थ्य या स्थिति में सुधार होना
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English → **mend (to repair) + phrase usage in early 19th century** → "on the mend" = in recovery
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - ✓ Recovering, Healing, Improving
 - ✗ Worsening, Deteriorating, Declining
- **Connotation:** Positive
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Someone in a hospital bed smiling as a doctor gives a thumbs-up.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

The financial markets, after a sudden collapse, appeared to be on the mend by the third quarter of the year. Companies slowly resumed hiring, and consumer confidence showed gradual signs of recovery. When an economy is on the mend, it signals

resilience and adaptation, often driven by a combination of fiscal strategies and public cooperation.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- ✓ She's on the mend after surgery. (वह ऑपरेशन के बाद ठीक हो रही है।)
- ✗ She's in mend now. (Incorrect structure)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Embrace being on the mend—physically, emotionally, or mentally—by slowing down and prioritizing rest. Healing isn't weakness; it's a strategic pause. Identify what fosters recovery and eliminate what's draining you. Whether from burnout or setbacks, give yourself grace and space. Progress begins the moment you allow yourself to mend.

- **Example + Grammatical Explanation:**

- She is on the mend after the accident. (दुर्घटना के बाद वह धीरे-धीरे ठीक हो रही है।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Phrasal, Intransitive): is on the mend
 - O (Object): — (None; verb is intransitive)
 - + (Adverbial Clause of Time): after the accident
 - ↳ S: the accident
 - ↳ V: — (Noun phrase; no verb inside this clause)

- **Common Collocations:**

- on the mend emotionally, economy on the mend, relationship on the mend

- **My Statement:**

- With the relief grant from the world bank, the country's economy is on the mend.
- After reconciliation, their relationship is on the mend.
- She is on the mend emotionally after talking to her confidant.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

2. Defenestrate (खिड़की से बाहर फेंकना) (Verb) (dee-fen-uh-streyt) (Dramatic)

- **Meaning (English):** To throw someone or something out of a window
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी को खिड़की से बाहर फेंकना
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin → **de (down from) + fenestra (window)** → defenestration → **verb form: defenestrate**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - ✓ Eject, Expel
 - ✗ Install, Retain
- **Connotation:** Negative, often humorous or extreme
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A cartoon where a chair is thrown out a skyscraper window.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Historically, defenestration became a political act, especially during the Defenestration of Prague. Modern usage includes symbolic defenestration—removing ideas or people from institutions. In tech, developers joke about "defenestrating" outdated code. Though dramatic, the term highlights a forceful removal, suggesting urgency or conflict.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- ✓ The rebels defenestrated the statue. (बागियों ने मूर्ति को खिड़की से बाहर फेंक दिया।)
- ✗ He defenestrated quickly. (Lacks object – incorrect)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Feeling overwhelmed? It might be time to defenestrate—figuratively, not literally. Toss out toxic thoughts, outdated routines, or unhelpful feedback that no longer belongs in your mental space. Like throwing a useless object out the window, clear mental clutter to make room for clarity, calm, and more constructive inputs.

- **Example + Grammatical Explanation:**

- They defenestrated the old television. (उन्होंने पुराने टेलीविजन को खिड़की से बाहर फेंक दिया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): They
 - V (Verb – Transitive): defenestrated
 - O (Object): the old television
 - + (—): — (No additional clause or modifier)

- **Common Collocations:**

- Defenestrate authority, Defenestrate the system, Defenestrated during protest

- **My Statement:**

- He defenestrated old thoughts from his cluttered mind, making space for clarity.
- She defenestrated his brothers' gloves out of anger.
- Orders were given to defenestrate the old system and replace it with a new one.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

3. Preposterous (हास्यास्पद) (Adjective) (pri-pos-ter-uhs) (Critical/Ironic)

- **Meaning (English):** Completely absurd or ridiculous
- **Meaning (Hindi):** बिल्कुल ही मूर्खतापूर्ण या हास्यास्पद
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin → *praeposterus* (putting last first, contrary to reason) → Preposterous
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - ✓ Absurd, Ludicrous, Bizarre
 - ✗ Logical, Sensible, Rational
- **Connotation:** Negative, sometimes humorous
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A man wearing a wool coat in the desert sun claiming it's "fashion."



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Some conspiracy theories are so preposterous that they challenge the boundaries of logic and reason. Claims that the moon landing was staged, or that Earth is flat, have been debunked multiple times, yet still attract attention. The preposterous nature of such theories calls for stronger emphasis on scientific literacy and critical thinking.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**
 - ✓ It's preposterous to believe that! (यह मानना हास्यास्पद है!)

- ✗ This idea is very preposterousest. (Incorrect comparative form)
- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**
 - When an idea feels preposterous, don't dismiss it outright. Sometimes, the most absurd thoughts spark innovation. However, learn to distinguish between the creatively bold and the genuinely illogical. Use "preposterous" thinking to challenge norms, but ground your actions in reason. Let absurdity provoke curiosity—not chaos.
- **Example + Grammatical Explanation:**
 - His claim was utterly preposterous. (उसका दावा पूरी तरह से निरर्थक था।)
 - **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): His claim
 - V (Verb – Linking): was
 - C (Complement – Adjective Phrase): utterly preposterous
 - + (—): — (No additional clause or modifier)
- **Common Collocations:**
 - Preposterous claim, Preposterous idea, Sounds preposterous
- **My Statement:**
 - The preposterous idea was rejected by several investors, but in the end, someone understood the concept and backed it.
 - Even though it sounds preposterous, we still need to invest in this project.
 - He made a preposterous claim that the Earth is flat.
- **My Notes:**
 - "at the end" → should be "in the end" (idiomatic usage).

4. Onslaught (आक्रमण) (Noun) (on-slawt) (Aggressive)

- **Meaning (English):** A fierce or sudden attack; an overwhelming influx
- **Meaning (Hindi):** एक भीषण या अचानक हमला
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Middle English → **slaught (slaughter) + on (prefix for direction)** → Onslaught
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - ✓ Assault, Barrage, Attack
 - ✗ Retreat, Withdrawal, Peace
- **Connotation:** Negative
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A person being overwhelmed by a flood of messages on their phone.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

The digital era has brought an onslaught of information that challenges our ability to process and prioritize. From news alerts to social media notifications, the average person is bombarded every hour. This constant onslaught not only strains mental bandwidth but often leads to decision fatigue and reduced productivity.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- ✓ The onslaught of complaints was unmanageable. (शिकायतों का हमला असहनीय था।)
- ✗ He onslaught the store. ("Onslaught" is a noun, not verb)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Prepare for an onslaught of distractions by setting boundaries early—turn off notifications, define work blocks, and schedule breaks. When you anticipate the mental flood, you can resist it better. Don't let an onslaught of minor demands derail your focus. Stay anchored, and let your priorities shield your productivity.

- **Example + Grammatical Explanation:**

- There was an onslaught of criticism after the announcement. (घोषणा के बाद आलोचनाओं की बौछार हो गई।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): an onslaught of criticism
 - V (Verb – Linking): was
 - + (Adverbial Phrase of Time): after the announcement

- **Common Collocations:**

- Onslaught of criticism, Media onslaught, Onslaught of data

- **My Statement:**

- The army experienced an onslaught from all directions at once.
- The onslaught of data was hard to manage, but over time, we learned how to segregate and optimize space.
- He faced an onslaught of public criticism due to his poor policies.

- **My Notes:**

- "onslaught" is a countable noun, so it needs an article ("an") or a determiner.

5. Debilitated (कमज़ोर किया हुआ) (Adjective) (duh-bil-i-tey-tid) (Grim)

- **Meaning (English):** Weakened or incapacitated physically, emotionally, or structurally
- **Meaning (Hindi):** शारीरिक, मानसिक या संरचनात्मक रूप से कमजोर
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin → **debilitare (to weaken)** → Debilitate → **Debilitated**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - ✓ Weakened, Enfeebled, Exhausted
 - ✗ Strengthened, Invigorated, Energized
- **Connotation:** Negative
- **Pictorial Scenario:** An old bridge with cracks labeled “debilitated structure.”



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

The country's infrastructure has become debilitated due to years of neglect and insufficient investment. Roads are crumbling, electricity grids are outdated, and sanitation systems are barely functional. A debilitated system is not just an inconvenience—it poses risks to lives and impedes progress. Timely intervention is essential to reverse this downward trend.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- ✓ The debilitated patient couldn't even sit up. (कमज़ोर मरीज़ बैठ भी नहीं पाया।)
- ✗ She was debilitatedly walking. ("Debilitated" is adjective, not adverb)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- When your productivity feels debilitated, assess what's draining your energy—mental clutter, lack of sleep, or unclear goals. Small, consistent actions like focused planning, breaks, or physical activity can help restore strength. Don't ignore early signs of burnout; reinforcements come from awareness, not denial. Strengthen your systems before they collapse.

- **Example + Grammatical Explanation:**

- The organization was debilitated by internal conflicts. (संगठन आंतरिक संघर्षों के कारण कमज़ोर हो गया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): The organization
 - V (Verb – Passive, Transitive): was debilitated
 - O (Object of the preposition "by" – Agent): internal conflicts

- **Common Collocations:**

- Debilitated patient, Debilitated system, Emotionally debilitated

- **My Statement:**

- The debilitated education system failed to achieve its intended purpose.
- When we are emotionally debilitated, we tend to undervalue our own decisions in comparison to others'.
- The debilitated patient needed extra attention every few hours.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]